concerned with environmental issues. This induced them to sign the ASEAN Agreement on Transboundary Haze Pollution in 2002 as an attempt to control the haze pollution in South East Asia which has been disturbing the environment of the region for long. Unfortunately, the attempt proved to be unsuccessful due to the outbreaks of the 2005 Malaysian haze and the 2006 South East Asian haze. The Cebu Declaration on East Asian Energy Security, the ASEAN-Wildlife Enforcement Network in 2005, and the Asia-Pacific Partnership on Clean Development and Climate are other significant environment related Treaties.

However, in the arena of political cooperation, it suffered a setback because of the ambivalent approach of ASEAN to address the human rights and democracy issues in the junta-led Myanmar. Despite global outrage at the military crack down on peaceful protesters in Yangon, the ASEAN has refused to suspend Myanmar as a member and also has rejected proposals for economic sanctions against the regime. This has caused concern, as the European Union, a potential trade partner, has refused to conduct free trade negotiations at a regional level for these political reasons. During the Twelfth ASEAN Summit in Cebu, several activist groups staged an anti-globalization and anti-Arroyo (Head of state and Government, the Philippines) rallies. According to the activists, the agenda of economic integration would negatively affect industries in the Philippines and would cause thousands of Filipinos to lose their jobs.[23] Therefore, the present issues and agenda for integration and furtherance of cooperation have to be worked out with utmost caution.